

Queen Moos



Talisman

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TALISMAN: THE FALL OF THE MAYA EMPIRE \*\*\*

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*Alice D. Le Plongeon.*

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# QUEEN MOO'S TALISMAN

## THE FALL OF THE MAYA EMPIRE

BY

ALICE DIXON LE PLONGEON.

AUTHOR OF

“HERE AND THERE IN YUCATAN”—“YUCATAN, ITS ANCIENT  
PALACES AND MODERN CITIES,” ETC.

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## QUEEN MOO'S TALISMAN

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*To Doctor Augustus Le Plongeon,  
whose works inspired these pages, their author  
dedicates them: not as a worth offering, but as  
A Small Token  
Of loving endeavor to gratify his oft expressed desire.*

*Brooklyn, N. Y., May, 1902.*

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*Engraved by F. A. RINGLER & CO., of New York, from photographs  
and drawings by*

DR. AUGUSTUS LE PLONGEON.

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## PRONUNCIATION AND DEFINITION OF MAYA PROPER NAMES.

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|         |                                               |                           |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| AAC     | (Ak, as in <i>dark</i> .)                     | Name of a prince.         |
| BALAM   | (Bā-lām, <i>a</i> as in <i>far</i> .)         | God of agriculture.       |
| CAN     | (Kän, <i>a</i> as in <i>far</i> .)            | Title of kings.           |
| CAY     | (Kā-ee.)                                      | Name of a high priest.    |
| CHICHEN | (Chee-chen, <i>chee</i> as in <i>cheek</i> .) | Name of a city.           |
| COH     | (Kō.)                                         | Name of a prince consort. |
| HOMEN   | (Hō-men, <i>o</i> as in <i>no</i> .)          | God of volcanic forces.   |
| KU      | (Koo, <i>oo</i> as in <i>moon</i> .)          | The Supreme Intelligence. |
| MAYA    | (Mā-yä, <i>a</i> as in <i>far</i> .)          | Name of a nation.         |
| MÓO     | (Mō, <i>o</i> as in <i>no</i> .)              | Name of a queen.          |
| MU      | (Moo, <i>oo</i> as in <i>moon</i> .)          | Name of a country.        |
| NICTÉ   | (Nik-tay.)                                    | Name of a princess.       |
| YUM     | (Yoom Keémil.)                                | God of death.             |
| CIMIL   |                                               |                           |
| ZOD     | (Zōdz.)                                       | Name of a queen.          |

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## PREFACE.

In justice to the author of "Queen Móo's Talisman", it may be recorded that at the time of its writing, there was no intention of allowing the verses to go into print; they were penned only for the one to whom they are dedicated.

The songs introduced have been arranged to the metre of the two or three ancient melodies yet occasionally heard among the natives of Yucatan. The one to the rain gods is a versification (set to the tune even now used in a sun-dance) of an old Maya prayer translated from that language by Dr. Le Plongeon and published in his work "Queen Móo and the Egyptian Sphinx." The melody to which the Love Song is set is not Maya. In connection with the lines touching upon love and pain it may be remarked that in the Maya language there is but one word to express both.

In this poem are represented as nearly as possible, the religious ideas of the Mayas, their belief in K U, the Supreme Intelligence; in the immortality of the soul, and in successive lives on earth before returning to the great Source whence all emanate; also their rites and ceremonies as gathered from traditions of the natives of Yucatan, the fresco paintings found at Chichen, and the books of ancient Maya authors.

As the general reader can hardly be expected to be familiar with the peculiar customs and ideas of the natives of Central America, these are sufficiently set forth in the Introduction, a careful perusal of which will greatly contribute to an appreciation of the poem.

Attention is also invited to the separate page containing a list of the Maya names and their meanings.

The second part of this narrative poem must be regarded not as a matter of belief on the part of the author, but solely as having been suggested by the belief of the natives who worked for Dr. Le Plongeon in his explorations among the ruins of Chichen.

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## INTRODUCTION.

The word Maya, though not familiar to modern ears, is a most interesting one to the antiquary. It appears to have originated with the great nation whose people, as well as their language and country, bore that name, even thousands of years back; their empire extended over the land comprised between the isthmus of Tehuantepec and that of Darien; known collectively to-day as Central America.

Dr. Le Plongeon has shown that in Yucatan and in Egypt the radical M A, of the word Maya, meant *earth* and *place*. This word was used by Hindoo sages to indicate *matter*, the *earth*, as it is found in their cosmogonic diagram. All matter being regarded as illusion, the word *maya*, in India, has that meaning. The mother of Buddha was Maya Devi (Beautiful Illusion). Maya is *matter*, the feminine energy of Brahma. But in the Indian epic, "Ramayana", Maya is spoken of as a great magician, an architect, a terrible warrior and famous navigator, who took forcible possession of, and settled in, the countries at the south of the Hindostan peninsula. Plainly, the poet personified as one hero the Maya colonists who long ago made their way westward, across the Pacific, and settled there.

On the shores of the Mediterranean we find nations whose ancestors seem to have been intimate with the Mayas, for the names of their country, of their cities, and of their divinities can be traced to the Maya tongue. Furthermore, their traditions, customs, architecture, mode of dress, weapons, and even their alphabetical letters are like those of the Mayas. From records in stone and MSS. we learn something of the philosophy of the Maya sages; and the same ideas are found among nations living in Asia and Africa.

Nothing could be more significant than the universality of the word Maya. In one country it is the name of a god or goddess; in another that of a hero or heroine; elsewhere that of a cast, tribe or country. This word is never used to indicate anything unimportant. In Greece the goddess Maia

was daughter of Atlas, mother of Hermes, the good mother Kubéle, the Earth, Mother of the gods. We see a vestige of her worship in the still popular festival of the Maya or May Queen, fair goddess of spring, May, that very month when the Earth, matter, Maya, lives again, refreshed by the nourishing rain which, then particularly, after a season of drought, pours down upon those latitudes where the Maya nation had its birth.

The Maypole dance is yet performed among the natives of Yucatan, the land where it probably originated. The dancers are invariably thirteen in number, which may be another reminiscence of the land submerged beneath the waves of the Atlantic on the thirteenth day of the Maya month of Zac.

This Maypole dance, called in Yucatan "Ribbon Dance" is unquestionably a vestige of sun worship; the ancients, versed in astronomy, thus celebrated the sun's entrance into Taurus, and the vernal equinox. The Maypole, as known in Europe, has been satisfactorily shown to be the remains of an ancient institution of Persia, India, and Egypt, where Maya civilization was carried in past ages. The May Queen is a personification of the goddess Maya, the feminine forces of nature; possibly too of that Maya country whence it came. In Yucatan there is no queen connected with the dance; there it is and was sun worship pure and simple.

In Yucatan, as in the British Isles and elsewhere, the pole is planted before the residences of leading citizens, and the dance is performed for a recompense. In Ireland the dancers wore over their other dress white shirts, a detail which becomes interesting in view of the fact that the Maya people always dress exclusively in white.

In Dr. Le Plongeon's prolonged studies among the remarkable Ruins on the Yucatan peninsula, after finding, by much patient endeavor, a clue to the hieroglyphic signs covering the walls of ancient palaces and temples, he clearly saw that the word CAN was inscribed in a variety of ways on all the buildings, and as he advanced in his studies, he learned that this had been the title of several monarchs who constituted a powerful dynasty. It is a remarkably interesting fact that the same title, spelled Khan, is to-day given to rulers in many of the Asiatic nations; furthermore, the principal emblem on the banners of those Khans is the serpent or dragon.

Continued research, including excavations and a close study of every object found, together with several tableaux of mural paintings, convinced Dr. Le Plongeon that he had succeeded in tracing certain incidents which occurred in the last family of the CAN dynasty, and which led to its

downfall. Upon studying the famous Troano MS., he found the same story recorded there; and the tragic events resulting from the acts of one member of that family, Prince Aac, are the theme of the present poem.

The scene is laid at Chichen, which appears to have been the favorite city of the CANS, judging from certain indications, among these the prevalence of the serpent as an ornament in all the buildings. These serpents are represented covered with feathers indicating that they were emblems of Maya potentates. On ceremonial occasions royal personages and high officials wore mantles of feathers, whose colors varied according to the rank of the individual; yellow being that of the royal family, red that of the nobility, and green that of the learned men. The word CAN has in the Maya language a great variety of meanings, as Dr. Le Plongeon explains in his works; it is the generic name for serpent.

The personages whom Dr. Le Plongeon succeeded in tracing were—the CAN, his Queen, Zoꝝ; their three sons—Cay, Aac, and Coh; and two daughters—Móo and Nicté. There was also an aged man named Cay, the High Priest, elder brother of the King. This venerable person is introduced in the early part of the poem. When he died, his nephew and namesake, Cay, succeeded to his position and title. Let it be noted that the High Priest was, as among the Egyptians and the Hindoos of old, superior in authority to the King himself.

At the death of King Can, his daughter Móo became Queen of Chichen. As among the Egyptians, and the Incas in Peru, so among the Mayas, royal brothers and sisters were obliged to marry each other; in Siam and some other places the same custom exists to-day. One of Móo's brothers had therefore to be Prince consort. Aac aspired to her hand, but Coh, a valiant leader in battle, and favorite with the people, was her own choice. This gave rise to lamentable events which caused the ruin of the dynasty, Aac refusing to be reconciled.

In a carving on stone, as well as in the Troano MS. and the Codex Cortesianus, Dr. Le Plongeon has found records of the destruction by earthquake, followed by submergence, of a great island in the Atlantic ocean. The author of the Troano MS. affirms that this land disappeared under the waves 8,060 years before the inditing of that volume. It is not known when the book in question was written, but judging from Egyptian records, the cataclysm must have occurred between ten and eleven thousand years ago. In the Maya books the lost land is called MU.



Lately Dr. Le Plongeon has discovered, in translating the inscriptions, written in Maya language with Egyptian and Maya characters, which adorn the faces of the Pyramid of Xochicalco, situated sixty miles to the southwest of the city of Mexico, in the State of Morelos, eighteen miles from the city of Cuernavaca, that said pyramid was a commemorative monument raised to perpetuate the memory of the destruction of the land of Mu among coming generations, and that it was made an exact model of the sacred hill in Atlantis which Plato in his *Timæus* describes as having been crowned by a temple dedicated to Cleito and Poseidon.

Looking at scenes depicted in mural paintings, one is driven to the conclusion that the Mayas were much addicted to the study of occult forces; they certainly used magic mirrors and appealed to haruspicy in their desire to foretell events. As may be seen in Dr. Le Plongeon's "Queen Mío", one tableau represents a wiseman examining the cracks induced by heat on the shell of an armadillo and the marks made by the vapor; from these signs he endeavors to read the fate of the young Princess Mío. The soothsayer, of the imperial family of China uses a turtle in the same way in a ceremony called *Puu*, for the royal family only, and in state affairs of exceptional importance.

Another tableau, also reproduced in "Queen Mío", represents one man in his feather mantle, mesmerizing another, showing that hypnotism was anciently made use of in Yucatan by priests and wisemen.

There can be no doubt that certain stones were considered efficacious, as talismans. Jadeite, particularly that of a beautiful apple-green, mottled with grey, was held in high esteem by the Mayas, if they did not regard it as sacred. They called it "Bones of the Earth" because it was the hardest stone known to them. Of the many varieties of jadeite, for which no less than a hundred and fifty names have been found, according to Fischer, the apple-green is the most rare.

In the great square of the old city of Chichen, Dr. Le Plongeon discovered, in the thick forest, two very ancient tombs with some of their decorative sculptures yet in place; those on one, enabled him to see that the tomb had been erected to the memory of Coh by his widow, Queen Mío. In it he found a statue of the Prince consort; also a large white stone urn, containing what proved, by chemical analysis, to have been human flesh, charred and preserved in red oxide of mercury. In the same urn, among other relics, was a beautiful ornament of green jadeite, like those decorating

the necks of various personages portrayed in the sculptures of certain edifices.

In connection with the statue it must be observed that the ancient Mayas held a belief similar to that entertained by the Egyptians, regarding the condition of the soul after death, and in the same way made a statue of the deceased, with the idea that this would give the individual a hold upon life. The natives who aided in bringing Coh's statue to light, out of the mausoleum where it had remained concealed for thousands of years, invariably spoke of it as the "Enchanted Prince", and frequently assured its discoverer that he had succeeded in finding it because he himself had dwelt there in past ages, and was one of the great men whose effigies were seen on all sides.

When the larger portion of the charred viscera found in the urn was burned, to reduce it to ashes, the natives standing by exclaimed—"A majestic shade ascends amid the smoke! It is the form of the enchanted Prince, that seems to fade into nothingness." So impressed were the men by what their imagination had evoked, that all ran from the spot in a state of agitation.

On the day when the statue, weighing three thousand pounds, was taken out of the monument, a party of hostile Indians suddenly emerged from the forest. One of their number was aged, and he remarked to his companions, "This represents one of our great men of antiquity." Then the young men paid homage to the statue by bending one knee, in a manner peculiar to those people.

Traditions of their ancestors are not altogether lost among the natives, as some travelers assert. Many still perform rites and ceremonies in the depths of forests or in unexplored caverns, in the darkness of the night, but keep their secrets to themselves, remembering the tortures inflicted on their fathers by the Spanish priests to oblige them to forego the religious observances that had been dear to those of their race for countless generations.

In connection with the song to the rain-gods it may be said that although the natives of Yucatan are to-day Catholic in name, they really prefer to render homage to some statue of their forefathers, and cling tenaciously to a few of their old divinities. Among these may be mentioned Balam (tiger), guardian of the crops, likewise appealed to as a rain-god. In a subterranean cavern a few miles from Chichen, there is an old image of a man with long

beard; this serves as a representation of Balam, and to it offerings are made. The antiquity of the carving cannot be doubted, similar ones existing on pillars at the entrance of a very ancient castle at Chichen. The figure in the cavern is on its knees, its hands are raised to a level with its head, palms upturned. On its back is a bag containing what the natives say is a cake made of corn and beans. The statue is now black, owing to the incense and candles with which its devotees frequently smoke it. Previous to the planting of grain, they place before it a basin of cool beverage made of corn, also lighted wax candles and sweet-smelling copal, imploring the god to grant an abundant harvest. When the crops ripen, the finest ears are carried to the grimy divinity by men, women, and children, who within the cavern dance and pray all day long, some of their quaint instruments serving as accompaniment to the Latin litanies which they chant, without having even the vaguest idea of their meaning.

The sun-dance mentioned in the Preface, is occasionally performed by Indians in Yucatan at the time of the vernal equinox. Twenty men take part—corresponding to the number of days in the ancient Maya month—but ten dress as women, whence it may be inferred that in olden times the dancers were of both sexes. All their faces are covered with masks of deer-skin, and each has on his head the inverted half-shell of a calabash, with turkey feathers standing up through a hole in the centre. They wear their usual spotless white garments, and sandals. Those clad as women are ornamented with large bead necklaces, principally red, in imitation of old Maya coin, and all the dancers have ear-rings. The hostile Indians<sup>[1]</sup> still pierce their ears as their ancestors did; the rank of a chief being indicated by his having a ring in the left ear only, or in the right, or in both.

The Master of the dance wears a stiff circular cap, surrounded by upright peacock feathers that sway with every movement, towering above all the dancers, and about his shoulders is a string of big sea-shells. From his neck hangs a metallic representation of the sun, in whose centre is an all-seeing eye within a triangle, from which depends a large tongue, symbol of power and wisdom.

One man carries a white flag on which is painted an image of the sun, and a man and woman on their knees worshipping it. Three men, apart from the dancers, play a clarinet, a *sacatan*, and a big turtle-shell beaten with deer-horns. The Master marks time with a rattle, and in his other hand has a

three-thonged whip like the flagellum of Osiris in Egypt; throughout the performance he remains standing close to the flag-staff.

Each dancer holds in his left hand a fan of turkey feathers whose handle is a claw of that bird; and in his right a small rattle made of a calabash shell, fancifully painted, containing pebbles and dried seeds. These rattles remind us of the sistrums used anciently in the temples of Egypt.

Around the pole on which the flag is furled, the dancers walk three times, with solemn tread, groping their way as if in darkness. Suddenly the flag is unfurled, the sun appears, all draw themselves up to their full height, raise their eyes and hands, and utter a unanimous shout of joy.

Now the dance commences, round and round the pole they go with various steps and motions, not graceful, but energetic and full of meaning. The dance is intended to represent, among other things, the course and movement of our planet around the sun. The chief and the dancers sing alternately:

“Take care how you step!”

“We step well, O Master!”

The melody and strange accompaniment are impressive and stirring, the rattles being particularly effective, now imitating the scattering of grain, then by a brisk motion of every arm sending forth a sound like a sudden rainfall on parched leaves, or a thunder clap in the distance, uniting with a shout raised by the dancers at the conclusion of each chorus. The fans, kept in motion, are emblematic of refreshing breezes.

The flag on the pole is undoubtedly a modern addition, simply to indicate what the dance originally was; of old, the pole itself represented the central orb; as the round towers did in Ireland, Persia, and India; the conical stones in Phoenicia; the pyramids and obelisks in Egypt, etc.—for in America, as in those countries, sun worship was the religion of the people.

Finally, the expression “Will Supreme” in the opening line of the poem is used in the sense of the Maya word UOL (or *will*) as applied by the Mayas of ancient times to the First Great Cause. This subject has been fully treated elsewhere by Dr. Le Plongeon.

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[1.](#) These Indians were in May, 1901, subjugated by Mexican troops, under General Bravo, after a prolonged struggle, and their capital of Chan

Santa Cruz was taken.

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## ARGUMENT.

### I.

A soul returns to earth to live again in mortal form as daughter of a potentate who rules over the Maya Empire. When the Princess reaches womanhood, the High Priest Cay, her father's brother, describes to her the destruction of the great land whence her people came; consults Fate regarding her future; gives advice to the Princess, and presents her with a talismanic stone, warning her that its loss might deprive her of her throne.

### II.

The Princess is wooed by two of her brothers, who thus become rivals. Her preference is for Coh, whom she weds. Cay prophesies to her that in another earthly incarnation she will again be the sister and wife of him she has chosen for consort.

Aac, the unsuccessful suitor, is filled with jealous wrath.

The sovereign Can, and his brother the High Priest Cay, both pass away. The Can's eldest son, also named Cay, becomes High Priest; Móo is Queen of Chichén, and her consort the supreme military chief.

### III.

The Prince consort is treacherously slain by his brother Aac, who admits his guilt, and is banished from the royal city, his elder brother warning him



that he, Aac, will cause the downfall of the Can dynasty.

#### IV.

Multitudes assemble to bewail the death of Coh and witness the funeral rites. His ashes are laid to rest and, with his charred heart, deposited in a stone urn, the widowed Queen places her talisman, hoping to thus link her destiny with that of Coh. She builds a monument over his mortal remains and a statue made to his likeness, and erects a memorial hall, upon whose exterior walls she inscribes an invocation to the *manes* of her consort.

#### V.

Notwithstanding his crime, Aac ventures to renew his entreaties. Failing in his desire, he brings about a war that causes the ruin of the country and people. Finally the Queen is captured and imprisoned by Aac; but she is rescued by loyal subjects and with them flees to foreign lands.

#### VI.

Aac, frustrated even in his hour of triumph, becomes a tyrant, oppresses those under his sway, turns a deaf ear to better promptings, and at last is killed in a contest with some of his own subjects, who would restrain him. The famous CAN dynasty is thus brought to its close.

## VII.

The Queen and her rescuers find tranquillity in the land of the Nile, where, long before, Maya colonists had made their homes. Here, Móo is received with open arms, and reigns again to the hour of her death.

## SEQUEL.

### I.

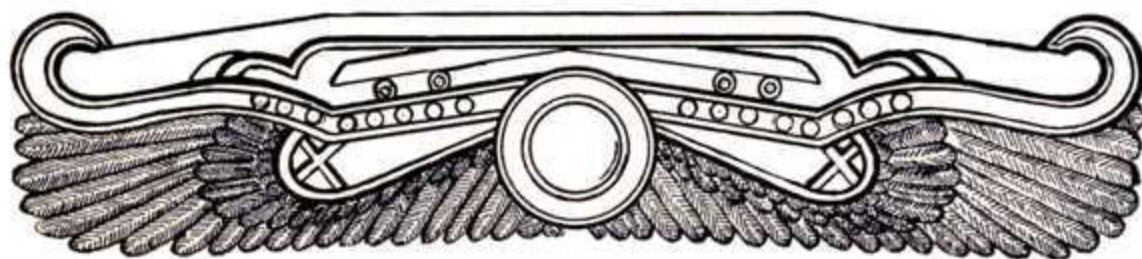
After many centuries have passed away, in a land far distant from that of the Mayas, Death snatches a baby girl from a loving brother. He stays upon earth; his lost sister again takes mortal form in another family; they meet and are united; the prophecy of the High Priest Cay being thus fulfilled. Together they journey to the land of the Mayas where, in the tomb of Coh, they find his heart and Móo's talisman, in the urn in which she had deposited it many centuries before.

### II.

Among the ruins of his palace Aac's spirit wanders desolate, pleading for the blessing of forgetfulness in rebirth.

### III.

The talisman brings visions of the long ago, voices of the Past; Cay, the Wise, still lives, still leads the way to paths of peace.





# QUEEN MÓO'S TALISMAN.

FALL OF THE MAYA EMPIRE.

I.

Moved by the Will Supreme to be reborn,—  
In high estate a soul sought earthly morn;  
Life stirred within a beauteous Maya queen  
Of noble deeds, of gracious word and mien.

Beneath the wing of Can, just potentate  
O'er Maya-land, of old an empire great,  
The Princess Máo knew all the joys of youth,  
Led on from day to day by Love and Truth.  
Earth's fairest blossoms at her feet were flung;  
About her slender form rare pearls were hung.  
The zephyr soft was music to her ear;  
The tempest wild awaked in her no fear.  
Within her being Past and Future slept,  
And into guileless mind no phantom crept.  
Heart sang with Nature's harmonies its best,  
Like warbling bird within a downy nest.  
But soon 'mong roseate tints more sombre thought  
Unto youth's bubbling spring dark ripples brought.

An aged man, divine love in his face,  
Led Princess Máo within a sacred place  
And there relating many a tale of old,  
Of years to come would something too unfold.  
Faint echos even now reverberate  
What he then told about the awful fate  
Of Mu, imperial mistress of the seas,  
Renowned for power and wealth thro' centuries.  
"O'erwhelmed was she in one appalling night  
When Homen, raging in his fearful might,  
Threw lofty peaks that lesser mountains crushed,  
And every life was into silence hushed.  
The rended mountains sent aloft their fire  
To meet the lightning's dart and then expire.  
From earth and sky incessant thunder broke;  
The bursting clouds forced back ascending smoke;  
Soon over all the seething billows swept:  
Death's lullaby the waters purled, and crept.

Then towering seas that gleamed as with snowcap,  
Tossed ships on land, while into Ocean's lap  
The land convulsed, her haughty mansions heaved.  
Waves onward dashed, as roaring flames they cleaved.  
In contest fierce, for mastery thus strove  
The elements, as luckless Mu they drove,  
With Death to battle, down in yawning hell;  
By all her gods forsaken, doomed she fell!"

"In blind despair, brother 'gainst brother fought;  
For feeble minds to frenzy soon were brought.  
Upon their knees men grovelled in the mud;  
In vain from crashing wall, from flame and flood,  
A shelter sought, demented they, with fear;  
And many a pleading eye met maniac leer.  
Fond mothers left their babes and raving fled;  
Thus fast and faster unto death all sped.  
Men ran distracted; climbed the stalwart trees,  
By earthquake rocked like craft on stormy seas.  
Cast off, they rushed to find in caverns deep  
A refuge safe; nor into those might creep;  
For when they drew anear, with thunderous sound  
The cavern mouths closed up as heaved the ground.  
In cities rich and great the house-tops swarmed  
With frantic men, by fear to brutes transformed.  
Around, the blackened, angry waters surged  
Till dwellings rocked, and melting soon were merged,  
Engulfed in dark abyss with writhing woe,  
All swiftly spent in one last awful throe!"

"The temples of the gods, the halls of state,  
Quick fell, but failed Lord Homen's greed to sate.  
High towers of stone in fragments crumbled down—  
Of perfect structure those, and wide renown.  
About man's shattered works the waters whirled,  
And he, to Terror's chariot lashed, was hurled  
To deep repose or spheres to man unknown,  
While man's body lay in ocean prone

While mangled body lay in ocean prone.  
Above the horrid sights and awful fear  
Dark waters rolled, mud-laden many a year.  
At dawn high crested waves, victorious,  
Exulted over Mu long glorious!  
Of what she was, some vestige yet may rest  
In depth profound 'neath Ocean's heaving breast.  
Perchance, when ages shall have fled, that land,  
Stripped bare—again unable to withstand  
Volcanic force, that will her life-springs start—  
May rise, and thus reborn again take part  
On this small globe, mere cosmic spark! yet still  
A universe whose powers await man's will.”

“To Ku the Mighty, hosts of souls went back  
Upon that thirteenth night in month of Zac.  
The dross returned to nursery of Earth—  
All form to fire and water owes its birth.  
Our wisemen then by edict made that date  
Each week, of thirteen days, to terminate.  
And noble hearts that day, with sacred rite,  
In urns are hid away from mortal sight;  
Then during thirteen days we all lament.  
When Maya nation mourns some dire event,  
On thirteen altars we our offering make;  
And thirteen guests at funeral board partake.  
That famous Mu may ne'er forgotten be,  
To grief belongs thirteen, by Can's decree.”

“For many years Mu's day of doom was feared,  
When those who into magic mirrors peered  
Saw visions grim; their minds were filled with dread.  
Not all believed that into Ocean's bed  
A land of vast dimensions could be thrust  
By Homen's power, yet many felt mistrust.  
But one there was more heedful than the rest,  
In science versed and with discernment blest;  
From Mu he sailed with those who deemed him wise—  
Our ancestor was he, they do not surmise.”



Our ancestor was he, thou dost surmise.

The Princess, deeply touched, in silence heard,  
With close attention, not to lose a word.

“To Oracle that ancestor gave ear—  
Yet he for self had not a thought of fear—  
And thus were many saved, of noble race  
That otherwise had left on earth no trace,  
With him for guide to this kind shore they came,  
Renewing here the glory of their name.  
Then all agreed that Can should Sovereign be.  
He earnestly desired they might be free  
From failings he deplored in that great State  
They’d left, because ’twas threatened by dark fate.  
He warned them oft—‘Of luxury and pride  
Beware!’—for well he knew how, side by side,  
Such foes can plunge the soul of man in mire.  
The arrogance of Mu roused Heaven’s ire;  
At her debauchery shocked, the gods forth fled;  
Deserted thus, in agony she bled.  
Simplicity and virtue stern, Can taught;  
With zeal his subjects held this righteous thought;  
Rejoiced in peace, and in dominion grew,  
Till far and near the Mayas throve anew.  
Can passed away before proud Mu was crushed,  
But his successor’s voice was yet unhushed.  
Now, Princess dear, we reach, it seems to me,  
Portentous years—come then, thy fate we’ll see.”

Thus spake the Sage, as o’er his raiment white  
He threw an ample cloak of feathers bright,  
Of royal yellow these and emerald-green,  
Beneath the sky resplendent was their sheen  
When forth he went, the Princess by his side,  
To sacred place that had no roof to hide  
The glorious light of day, but walled so high  
That none could see within while passing by.

Móo's simple mind was here struck with amaze,  
For where the wiseman fixed his earnest gaze  
An armadillo thence out crept, nor stayed  
Till at her feet, as if it thus obeyed  
A force unseen or was by fetter bound;  
But none appeared upon that hallowed ground.  
The aged man this creature gently placed  
Above a brasier which the Princess faced;  
As in its depth clear-burning charcoal lay,  
With pity moved she cried aloud—"Nay! nay!"  
But he—"Think not that I would torture this  
Or aught that is; could I then hope for bliss?  
Each being in Creation works its way  
To perfect rest, all must this law obey.  
From Ku all emanate, are thence divine;  
Eternal law ordaineth all combine  
To aid; each one of us must give and take.  
This creature, serving us, will progress make,  
And we are lifted up in reaching down;  
Thus by endeavor we ourselves may crown.  
Learn then, this little friend shall nothing feel,  
Experience shall to thee a truth reveal.  
Thy slender fingers I but touch, and lo!  
All feeling goes, no heat therein doth glow.  
Now move thy hand, 'tis free again dost find;  
This holy law to suffering flesh is kind;  
Who knoweth this, sensation can enchain,  
And armadillo shall not suffer pain."

'Twas true indeed, for tranquilly it stayed  
Above the burning coal, quite undismayed;  
While such the heat endured that soon its shell  
O'erspread became with misty lines. To spell  
What weighty meaning auspice might conceal  
The seer watched, its purport to reveal.  
What promised he—of what did he then warn—Could  
she evade the fate foretold that morn?

For house of Can he prophesied defeat,  
Through dark revenge its overthrow complete;  
By jealousy brought on, and Móo its source,  
Tho' blameless she, herself bereft of force.

Then back to Cay's sanctum both returned,  
Móo's heart oppressed by much that she had learned.  
This mood the Sage rebuked and bade her hear  
His words: "Dear child, thy path lies straight and clear;  
Whate'er may hap, no thought of wrath outsend;  
This breedeth ill and nothing doth amend.  
In spite of many wrongs thou may'st endure,  
Of fame this oracle doth thee assure.  
'Twould seem a jest to bid thee do aright,  
For man, alas! is in a woful plight!  
He gropes along in quest of Wisdom's ray  
And, ever seeking, often goes astray.  
In noble deeds exert thy human might;  
Let acts of kindness be thy best delight.

To give advice for all life's days who dare?  
Can one foresee what pitfall may ensnare  
Thy feet in paths where thou art bound to tread?  
But come what may, thy soul must nothing dread.  
Hate's sting fear not; if thou no hatred give,  
Its venom reacheth not what shall outlive  
All trivial griefs and wrongs, thyself divine,  
Bring what life will, let not thy soul repine.  
Aid those who seek thy help; there is no joy  
Surpassing this, unmingled with alloy.

We know that conflict is a law of life,  
For matter feeds itself by constant strife;  
The Will Eternal maketh this decree;  
We feel results; the *why* we do not see.  
The Heart of Heaven, throbbing with thine own,  
Knows ALL IS WELL. The Infinite alone  
Embraces all, and ever lures us on

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To blissful rest where all return anon.  
In paths of doubt and fear all onward go,  
But knowing little, waver to and fro.  
At times disconsolate, men yet aspire,  
Labor and sigh for bauble they desire;  
For riches, joys and honors, they contend;  
But on the funeral pyre these all must end.  
Let thy wish be to find the highest gift,  
The Light Divine, 't will ever thee uplift.  
When grief shall rend thy heart, seek thine own soul;  
Shut out life's din, and find that sacred goal.

A talisman I give thee—jadeite green,  
'Twill ever lend thee intuition keen.  
Its wearer may with love herself surround,  
For with attractive force it doth abound.  
Would one deceive, and traitor prove to thee,  
His mind with this thou wilt quite plainly see.  
Thro' centuries this talisman can bind  
Two souls—desiring this, the way thou'lt find.  
But keep it sacredly for thee alone;  
If thou lose this a foe will seize thy throne.“

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II.

The daughter of the Can was early wooed  
By Aac, her brother, who with fervor sued;  
A brother-prince by law must consort be;  
In choice of one the future Queen was free.  
And 'twas for Coh alone her own heart yearned;  
Aac seeing this with jealous anger burned.  
Those brothers fought as strangers cruel might;  
Both wounded fell, a rueful, horrid sight!

Coh far and wide for valiant deeds was known;  
The Princess Múo her courage oft had shown;  
That they should mated be was right and just;  
Thus by the Can, who in them put full trust,  
Their nuptials sanctioned were, and many a day,  
On pleasure bent, the people had their way;  
For Can regaled them all with lavish grant.  
At break of day was heard the deep-toned chant:

Lord of day we are Thine!  
On our path deign to shine—  
                                        Holy Light!  
Mortals glory in Thy might.  
When night flees before Thy ray  
We our voices lift, and pray—  
                                        Great Light!

Scarce rose the sun when crowds on sport intent,  
From every door in quest of pleasure went;  
All left their homes the time to pass away,  
And on the air rang many a joyous lay  
Of boy and girl who simple frolic sought,  
And gaily sang with little care or thought.

Hear life's jingle, come along!  
All should mingle with the throng;  
Clasp my hand, dear, haste with me—  
Say not nay, for I love thee!  
Quit thy nonsense or begone!



I am not thus lightly won.  
Let's go onward to the dance,  
Give me but one tender glance!  
Cease thy teasing, I'll not go!  
'Tis decided, thou must know.  
Hear life's jingle! join the throng;  
Youth and pleasure stay not long.

With shades of eve came other dancers gay,  
Their smiles enticing young and old away;  
As in and out about the streets they roamed,  
They joked and sang while many a goblet foamed:

On our dress of spotless white  
We are wreathing garlands bright;  
And will sing, kiss, sip,  
With laughing, ruddy, lip,  
Far away into the night.

Days of gladness soon take flight,  
Love's sweet nectar do not slight  
Let us sing, kiss, sip,  
And light-hearted gaily trip,  
While our vows we once more plight.

And well they did to quaff the honeyed cup—  
Why keep the mind with bitter thoughts filled up,—  
The watchful gods no pity ever take  
On those who sullen gloom will not forsake;  
But on bright smiles, reflecting cheerful heart,  
Frown not, e'en if gay Folly play a part.

O beauteous night! when lingering footfall strayed,  
And stars reflected seemed where firefly played,  
Each leaflet murmured lover's tenderness;  
Soul's ecstasy was pure and fathomless.  
O mystic Love! to every trivial thing  
A new and holy charm dost ever bring,

With light and joy, to all touched by thy ray  
Creation glows for him who feels thy sway.  
Of one we love Perfection is the name,  
For love is breath of God, all potent flame!  
Thus 'twas a lover sang, with rapture filled,  
When bird on leafy bough had softly trilled:

Ah! bird so gay,  
Take not thy flight!  
With dulcet lay  
My heart delight!  
Stay by me here,  
For thou art dear—  
Tho' one I love is yet more dear!

Ah! floweret fair,  
With breath of Morn  
Upon the air  
Thy perfume's borne;  
Thy life's too fleet,  
For thou art sweet—  
Tho' one I love is yet more sweet!

Ah! limpid dew,  
Fair pearl of Night—  
That doth anew  
To petal bright  
Give charm to lure—  
Thou art so pure!  
Tho' one I love is just as pure.

In drowsy bud Night breathed. "May love here bide!"  
But love and pain are one, so floweret sighed  
When glistening dew to perfumed petal clung,  
Imploring—"Wake me not! by zephyr swung,  
Ah! let me linger in this happy state!  
Ope not the way to pang that may await."

But lovely Morn appeared with rosyate ray

But lovely morn appeared with roseate ray,  
And soon the god of day chased tears away;  
Earth throbbed anew, leaves quivered with delight;  
Flowers laughed, "We love! we live! thanks be to Night!"  
In silent, sombre hour of deep repose  
All form drinks in life's force that ever flows;  
And from the tranquil vale of balmy rest  
Each being leaps—love's joy they all attest.  
On globes revolving night must follow day;  
The universe doth this same law obey.

Pleasure with pain is mingled, gently kissed  
By Sorrow, or regret for something missed;  
As plaintive minor blends with major strain,  
Fair Light's attendant shades adorn her train.  
And Móo upon her marriage day had mourned,  
For she by Oracle had been forewarned  
That Coh from her might in the future time  
Be torn by dastard treachery and crime.  
Beyond that time the wiseman too could see  
That Móo, bereft and harshly wronged, would flee.  
More strange than all, the Oracle foretold—  
"In bitter woe this thought may thee uphold:  
Both will return; the sister thou wilt be  
And wife once more of him awaiting thee."

The Prophet Cay taught Can's eldest child;  
With mystic lore their time was much beguiled;  
For pupil would some day the High Priest be,  
When his preceptor should from earth go free.  
Surrounded by his volumes old, the Sage  
In search of truth read over every page.  
On rare occasions he before the crowd  
Came forth to speak, and all to his will bowed.  
Prophetic words were his, sincere and wise;  
The Can obeyed when Cay deigned advise.  
Revered by high and low, the honored Sage  
Could by his will much pain and grief assuage—

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Nor ever aid withheld, for he loved all—  
But soon the Lord of life would him recall.  
More than he did no one in mortal frame  
Could do, aspiring to the Holy Flame,  
To keep soul free from earth. His nourishment—  
Whereon the sun its vital ray had sent—  
Pure water, simple fruit, white flesh of bird,  
Was more than he required, he oft averred.  
In mystic posture he besought Mehen,  
The Word, that he might wisdom pure attain.

He could at will ascend from solid ground  
And float above, while crowds up looked spellbound.  
Soon after Sovereign Can, without a throe,  
Cay passed away, bewailed by high and low.  
Around his flaming pyre, bowed in the dust,  
All wept for him in whom they'd put their trust.

Can's first-born son then filled the Pontiff's place;  
Thenceforth he would by every means efface  
The jealous hatred rankling in Aac's mind;  
But he alas! with passion grew more blind;  
For now that Móo was Queen, and consort Coh,  
Her love he ne'er could win, nor him o'erthrow.  
To Móo came other joys with baby lips;  
Pure bliss from soft caressing finger tips.



*Plate III.*

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III.



Beyond her palace wall Móo heard the chant  
Of worshiper imploring Heaven to grant  
Its bounteous rain, fresh life to Mother Earth,  
The parched land to revive and save from dearth:

When the Master doth rise  
To appear in the east  
The four corners of heaven are released,  
And my broken accents fall  
Into the hands of Him who giveth all.

When clouds from east ascend  
To the Orderer's throne—  
Ah Tzolan, who thirteen cloud-banks rules alone—  
Where the lords cloud-tearers wait,  
Biding the will of Ah Tzolan the Great,

Then the Keeper who sees  
The gods' nectar ferment,  
With these guardians of crops is content;  
They his holy offerings place  
Before the Father, pleading for His grace.

I too my offering make,  
Of beauteous virgin bird,  
And myself lacerate, breathing holy word.  
Thee I love! then heed my cry!  
My offering place in hands of the Most High.

Could Móo in far off days forget that prayer?  
Ah no! for as it died upon the air  
A messenger appeared; his words sought vent—  
Ill tidings had to him their fleetness lent.

Poor human heart! that blenches, quivers, shrinks,  
Appalled at fatal stroke that swift unlinks  
Two lives attuned to one harmonious breath.  
O loving heart! thy cruel foe is Death.

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With *this* compared all other anguish pales;  
To soothe *this* pang no human aid avails.

Affrighted eyes met hers—"Speak! speak!" she cried.  
Heart knew and leaped—"Thou art alone!" it sighed.

In broken words the dire event was told—  
The herald was forbidden to withhold  
The worst. Then fiercely battled in Móo's breast  
Wild rage and grief, while he obeyed her hest.

Scarce gone the man, when doubt brought some relief—  
He must be mad! Allured by this belief  
She fixed her gaze on Hope's illusive beam—  
"Untrue the tale! a frightful, ghastly dream!  
He dead! Impossible! Sore wounded, yes,  
As oft; his voice would ease her keen distress.  
The valiant Coh could never vanquished be,  
Victorious from every fight came he."  
Thus to herself, forbidding other thought,  
And from her palace rushed, not caring aught  
For those who would detain her steps, she fled  
To meet the Prince; her servitors she led.

He came surrounded by a mighty crowd.  
"Make way for us!" the Queen's men cried aloud—  
"The Queen is here!" Her breath was all but spent.  
The bearers stopped; with cries the air was rent.  
Then bending low, her arms about him flung,  
She gasped! To his, cold set, her hot lips clung.  
Beneath an arch of warriors' shields upraised,  
She saw, she felt; in death Coh's eyes were glazed.  
Ah! woful sight! 'twas more than Móo could bear—  
She fell, unconscious of the tender care  
On her bestowed, as homeward borne apace;  
Far happier had she been in Death's embrace.

'Neath holy Ceiba tree, upon the ground,  
Struck down by one unknown, Coh had been found

Struck down by one unknown, Coh had been found.  
Whence came the treacherous foe? From foreign land?  
Beloved by all was Coh—Whose then the hand?  
With brother's blood would Aac himself imbrue?  
This thought in vain she struggled to subdue.  
“I rave!” she cried; her mind with doubt was torn;  
Those brothers royal were from one womb born.  
“O wretched man! O cruel, monstrous fate!  
Our Prince was sacrificed to mortal hate!  
Unarmed was he when came the stealthy foe  
Behind, to strike unseen the vengeful blow.  
Thrice stabbed, Coh reeled and fell. Then turned to flee  
His slayer, who rejoiced alive and free!”

With passion's anguish riven, loud she moaned—  
Could she forgive? Must this crime be condoned?  
A deed so foul by her own brother base—  
What act could e'er such deep-set blot efface?  
For brother-consort by a brother slain  
Must she herself with bloody vengeance stain?

To dark despair the Queen bereft gave way,  
Nor heeded anyone who tried to stay  
Her grief, until the Pontiff Cay came—  
Successor to the Sage who'd borne that name.  
Alone with Móo he groaned, “'Tis Aac I see!  
His life is ours to take; but this would be





*Plate V.*

With crime as infamous ourselves to brand—  
Let not two fratricides accurse the land!  
Our impulse to avenge must be suppressed;  
Nor may our soul by anger be possessed.  
Let Aac himself convict. Do thou, I pray,  
Request his presence here—he'll quick obey.”

Aac's handsome face wore mask of grief until  
The High Priest sternly thus expressed his will:  
“Our dauntless Coh is slain by one unknown;  
The coward's blood for this crime should atone.  
The Maya nation mourns—be thine the task  
To see the culprit found—'tis all we ask.”

Aac's features changed, with ardor he exclaimed—  
“Not so! no blameless man shall be defamed  
For what my passion wrought—all mine the guilt!  
No clemency beg I—do as thou wilt.”

There spake Aac's better self; just thought inbred  
Outbreathed. With pity touched, Móo's loathing fled.  
Nor could a child of Can know aught of fear;  
Aac boldly stood, the Pontiff's word to hear.

“Thou shalt live on; hast made thyself accurst!  
Not thus will we—let fools for vengeance thirst.  
From Chichen, go! thy face we would not see.  
An edict from our hand shall safeguard thee;  
For, mark this well, the people soon must know  
Prince Aac alone hath dared to deal the blow.

I see that war upon us thou wilt bring,  
And finally, thyself proclaim as king.  
Afflicted Móo will feel thy cruel ire;  
Thus wilt thou weave for thee a fate most dire.  
Myself, thy elder brother, thou'lt degrade;  
Cans' dynasty shall fall, by thee betrayed.”



IV.



Sun-Scorched, for tears athirst was Chichen's square;  
The funeral bed 'mid wailing crowds rose there.  
Here many noble structures had a place,  
With carvings red and gold upon their face.  
The lofty stronghold in their midst, appeared  
Like pyramid of human beings reared;  
From base to summit on each side were seen  
Brave men who for their chief felt sorrow keen.  
On temple's mound crowds flocked to view the square,  
And hum of million voices filled the air.  
Each road that led within the city wall  
Was packed with mourning populace; and all  
Betrayed the grief they felt. The flowers fair  
In well-kept beds, the burden seemed to share  
Of nation's woe; all drooped their dainty heads,  
Entreating those sweet tears that heaven sheds.

With Priestess Nicté, Móo was near the pyre,  
To light the cedar logs with sacred fire.  
Piled high were these, with odorous plants between;  
And many lovely garlands too were seen.  
The priests in flowing robes were stationed round:  
By solemn rite the rank of each was bound.  
First those in yellow clad, the sun-god's sheen;  
Then soothing wisdom-ray, fair nature's green;  
The next in line of blue robes made display,  
Grief sanctified—the mourners sad array,  
Beyond stood many others all in white;  
And last, full armed as ready for the fight,  
The orators of war, in gowns of red.—  
Their ardent words to victory oft had led.  
Long lance they bore, as on the battle field  
Where glowed their eloquence—nor would one yield,  
Except to Yum Cimil, but onward pressed  
And dauntless to the last urged on the rest.  
These now restrained the crowd that thronged the ground:  
In that vast square no tearless eye was found.

Móo's sister Nicté, priestess of the Light,  
Sustained the hapless Queen thro' funeral rite.  
Coh's heart, concealed within a close shut urn,  
Was near the corpse, to char while that should burn.  
That flames might higher leap and quick consume,  
Fine scented oils, the hot air to perfume,  
By priestly hand were lavishly out-poured  
Upon the shroud of him whom all deplored.

Around the pyre, with measured step and slow,  
His comrades, arms reversed, must three times go  
Unto the left, anear the funeral bed,  
That evil spirits might not reach the dead.  
Thrice round they went, their object to attain,  
All chanting as they marched, a solemn strain.

At signal given by trumpets' ringing sound,  
Hushed was the wailing of the crowd around.  
Móo grasped the torch that would, from body dead,  
Release the soul yet linked to funeral bed.  
Alone she set ablaze the corners four—  
A sacred right none could dispute, nay more!—  
Her duty 'twas as true and loving wife,  
To light the wood, speeding the soul to life  
Or dreamless sleep, the Will Supreme to bide.  
The multitude, when Móo the torch applied,  
Upon their knees, their brows to earth, were bowed  
Until the priests, "Arise! All's well!" cried loud.

The priests and mourners now, each one in place,  
Around the pyre, with sad and measured pace,  
Unto the right, three times the way must tread;  
To honor thus the memory of their dead.  
And when the hero's form was wrapped in fire,  
Two mated doves, pure white, loosed near the pyre,  
Up soared—of liberated soul the sign,  
From prison freed, no fetter to confine;  
Yet more. fair symbols of creative force.

Of life and death and all that is, the Source.

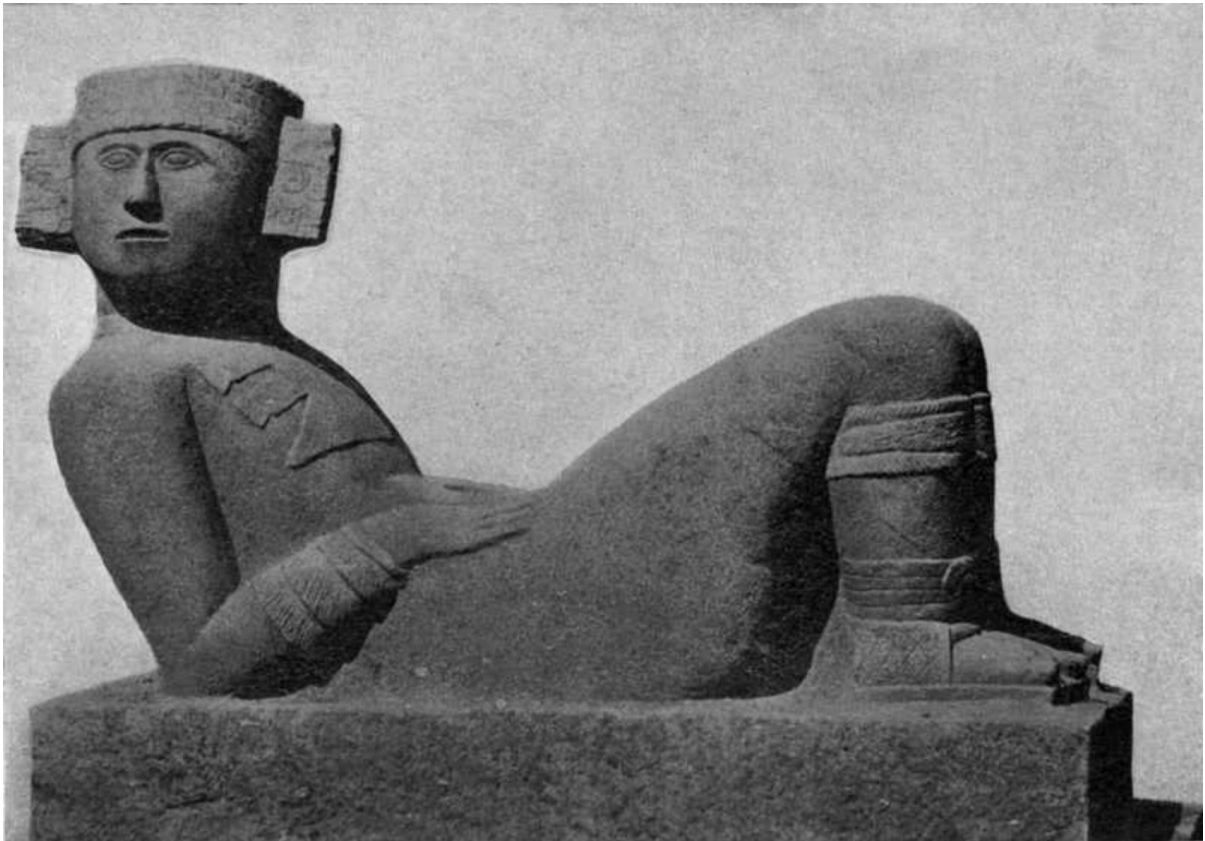
The grace divine was fervently implored  
While hissed the leaping flame and loudly roared.  
Transparent burned the wood with ruddy glare;  
Melodious voices rose o'er trumpet blare:

Thro' earth-life our footsteps lead,  
Guide us into peace eternal,  
Till from all desire we're freed,  
And perceive Thy Light Supernal.

Down sank the pile; priests chanting nearer drew  
And on expiring flames sweet incense threw.

Speed thee now to realm of bliss,  
Cast aside the thought of strife,  
Tho' each eye thy face will miss  
And we mourn thee all our life!

Intoned the priests and slow their bodies swayed,  
The dying embers fanned, and singing stayed  
While these by murm'ring winds were borne away—  
List where they might, they would life's law obey.



*Plate VI.*

Afar they floated on the zephyr's wing:  
No triumph now would Coh to Mayas bring.  
Disconsolate, the Queen in anguish cried:  
"Would that I had with my beloved died!  
Why tarry here? My soul entreats release!  
I too will sleep on Death's soft couch of peace."  
From thought so weak, by Nicté she was freed  
And tottering reason saved from foolish deed.

Then came the date of Mu, the thirteenth day,  
When hearts of noble men were laid away.  
Where sacred fire had liberated Coh,  
The people once again were lost in woe.

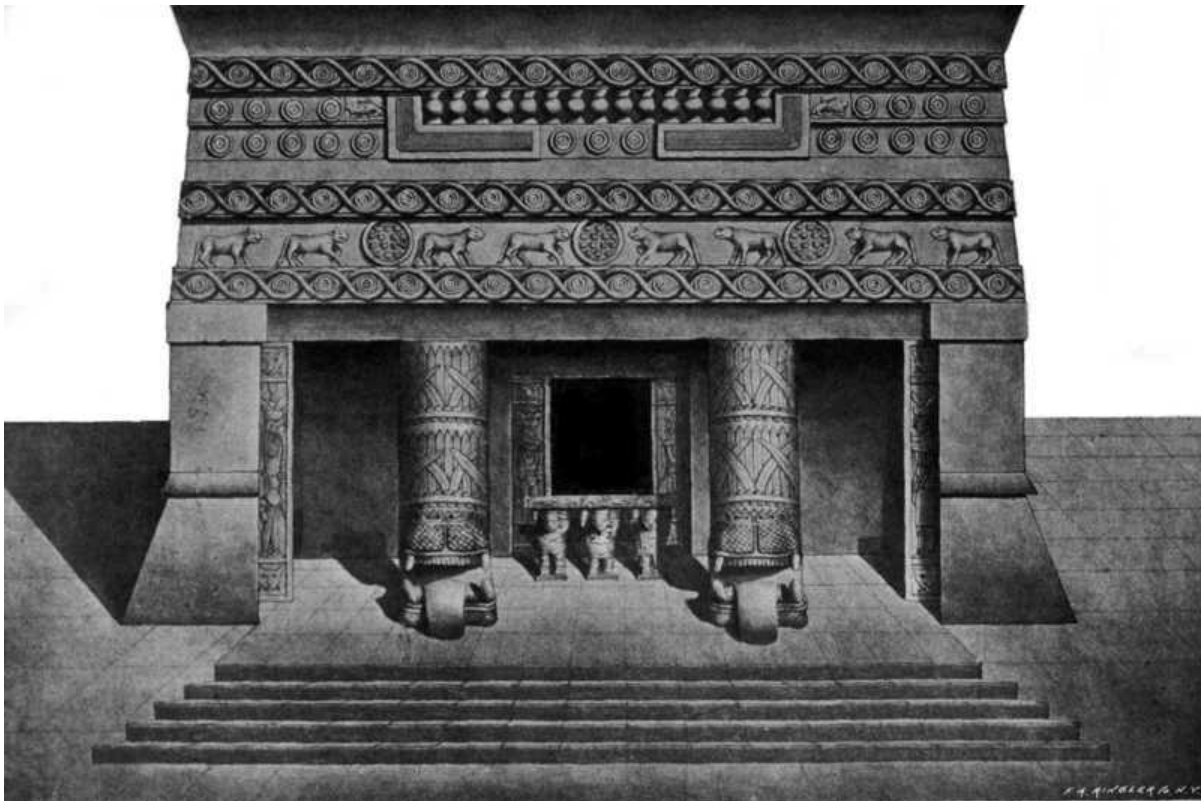
Beneath the earth, shut close in virgin urn,  
Wherein it safe would bide the soul's return,  
The heart of hero slain was put to rest  
By those who in its love were more than blest.  
Before the marble lid closed o'er the urn,  
Upon that heart for which she'd ever yearn  
The widowed Queen with loving homage laid  
Her Talisman, at Cay's order made;  
By his strong will invested for her sake  
With qualities she ever might partake.

Thus from the day this gift became her own,  
When she'd been warned its loss might her dethrone,  
The gem had nestled close about her heart.  
But now, most eager she with this to part;  
For Cay had affirmed its force could bind  
Two souls thro' time, if she the way would find.  
Coh gone, could Móo rejoice on sovereign throne?  
Ah no! far rather than a Queen alone,  
A fugitive she'd be in boundless space,  
Assured she would at last behold *his* face.

When talisman touched heart, a great calm fell  
O'er Móo; to think they would together dwell

Once more, they two, within her mind distilled  
A solace sweet that all her being filled.  
Should earth recall them, as in time it must,  
Each would the other seek in perfect trust;  
From spheres of bliss, if parted, they would strive  
To meet again and keep love's pain alive.

Close by the urn a counterpart of Coh  
Was set; as long as that endured below,  
Desiring thus, he could to earth return  
If e'er his soul for mortal life should yearn.  
Walled close around, cut from a solid block,  
That statue could the fleeting ages mock.  
Secure from tempest and from mortal eyes,  
This form Coh's will alone might bid arise.  
The pose it had been given showed regal state,  
The boundary lines of Maya Empire great;  
Where Cans, for justice famed, long ruled; rich land  
Of men renowned for actions brave and grand.



*Plate VII.*

Now on the spot a monument was reared,  
On four sides marble steps; and there appeared  
The emblems royal carved in fine white stone;  
A leopard crowning all, Coh's name made known.

The tomb complete, Máo likewise built a shrine  
In honor of the Prince now hailed divine.  
Of grand proportions stood that edifice;  
No charm that art could lend would one there miss.  
Here faithful hearts might manes sometimes greet,  
And on the altar lay an offering meet.  
On walls within the artist toiled amain,  
Portraying there the life of chieftain slain.  
On outer wall was graved a loving thought—  
Her Consort's mem'ry thus the Queen besought:  
"Cay witness beareth—earnestly doth Máo  
Hereby invoke her warrior-prince, great Coh!"





V.

And yet again Aac dared his cause to plead,  
His hand out reached that Máo might love concede.  
Mad! mad! he surely was—Can one plant deep  
The seed of hate, and then hope love to reap?

Events that Cay had foretold drew near;  
For self-willed Aac cast o'er the land dark fear.  
Enraged, a pretext he failed not to seek  
For war; and soon he caused the soil to reek  
With blood of men; for him they bravely fought,  
And led by him dire devastation wrought.  
When nearly all the land bowed 'neath his sway,  
Once more he tried with her to have his way;  
By messenger himself would thus demean:  
“To Máo, Aac yields, if she will be his queen.”

Could mortal strive to rouse with greater zeal  
Fierce hate and pity kill? Her fall, his weal,  
He'd thus make one. His queen! O hateful thought!  
'Twas plain the war that he ungrateful sought,  
Had prompted been by fixed desire to reign,  
And with the throne its Queen too he'd obtain.  
With just wrath filled Máo scorned the victor's plea—  
Lose all she rather would, her palace flee.

Too soon indeed was this to come about,  
Cay's prophecy no longer one could doubt;  
For Aac without delay acquired new force,  
Nor cared who fell beneath his reckless course.  
At last exulted he in Máo's defeat,  
And deeds were done that time could ne'er delete.  
The noble Pontiff was at once abased  
By Aac, who deeply thus himself disgraced.

When Máo's defenders lay around her slain,  
Her freedom she no longer could retain;  
Then captive she was led to meet her fate.  
Within Aac's breast now battled love and hate.

Yet dared he not that heinous sin commit,  
Compel what woman's heart would not permit.  
He hoped she soon would plead to be set free,  
And since all else was lost for her could she  
Withstand his ever strong desire? Relent  
She must—to be his consort now consent.

Móo looked for death; she would surrender life,  
Escaping thus all further pain and strife.  
But jailers were by faithful friends embroiled;  
At heavy cost Prince Aac's designs they foiled.  
Success was theirs, and guarding her with care,  
They gained the coast, great oceans storms to dare.

“Dear native land, where tender mem'ries cling,  
No other spot such happy years can bring!”  
Thus to himself each, silent, said. The past  
Knew no appeal; the lot of all was cast;  
The future might, perchance, hold something yet.  
And when the sun arose, the sails were set,  
That all might find on distant, foreign shore,  
New homes, where peace would bless their days once more.  
Devoted subjects they, renouncing all  
To rescue captive Queen, whose complete fall  
From sovereign power forbade a hope of gain;  
Their only wish to save her further pain.  
Thus they with her now fled from Aac's mad hate,  
Untouched by fear of what might them await.

Afar the voyagers went from place to place,  
And stayed at length where men of Maya race—  
Bold navigators they for centuries back—  
Had made a home, and nothing there could lack.

---





VI.

Thus Aac remained with power complete at last;  
But all his triumph was by gloom o'ercast;  
He writhed in torture when, each night, he thought  
How great the cost at which his throne was bought.  
Worse yet, he'd lost the stake for which he played—  
To fail in winning Múo, all else outweighed.  
Upon his soul wrath preyed till spent; and now  
Dark melancholy hovered o'er his brow.  
Unsatisfied, unresting, ne'er at ease,  
Seek where he might, nothing in life could please.  
Alone he ruled, none dared his word gainsay;  
But this could not his discontent allay.

'Twas not remorse that ever brought him pain,  
But fierce regret that he had failed to gain  
That chief desire of his unyielding will:  
This bitter thought his mind would ever fill.  
Defied and baffled in his hour of might,  
He hated all who had contrived Múo's flight.  
Each one suspected quickly met dark fate;  
But cruel deeds could not Aac's ire abate.  
By passion swayed like tree in tempest blast,  
All wish for good and right aside he cast.  
One satisfaction yet remained to him—  
The flight of time should not his victory dim;  
His palace walls should bear upon their face,  
In carvings deep that time would ne'er erase,  
His triumph over all who strove in vain  
To hold him back from what he would attain.  
And thus 'twas writ above his palace door,  
Above the polished, crimson-painted floor.

Now came the days when Mayas knew no peace  
'Neath Aac's harsh rule, and war that did not cease.  
With sacred rite they strove to know the will  
Of Can the Good; response came not, yet still  
They plead; by holy fire would feign invoke  
Some aid; and mystic power at last awoke

To seer's gaze the mighty Can of old,  
Whose visage stern and sad his sorrow told.  
No hope or promise in that face was read;  
The country still would be by tyrant bled.

Again the seers besought, and Coh appeared—  
Brave prince who had to all himself endeared—  
Averted was his gaze, his hands upraised,  
Aggrieved he seemed to be and sore amazed;  
But not a word expressed; no hope gave he  
That from the tyrant Aac they might be free.

There came a final day of vengeance dire,  
When subjects turned upon their haughty Sire.  
E'en to this time may yet be seen the place  
Where he was killed by one of Maya race;  
Where last he took his stand upon that height  
Within his palace grounds, there forced to fight  
In self-defence or yield to prisoner's lot;  
Restraint his outraged subjects planned. 'T was not  
Their wish, e'en now, to slay the wilful man  
Whose being throbb'd with blood of honored Can.

Aac towered there amid his fallen men,  
Defiant, raging, livid, and 'twas then  
That one named Pacab flung his arms aside,  
Approached the Prince, and as he neared him cried—  
“Now yield thyself; we would not do thee wrong;  
Full well we know all rights to thee belong.  
Thy safety we desire and not thy life,  
Tho' thou hast filled our land with grief and strife.”

With one fell blow Aac struck the speaker dead,  
Then shook the dripping axe above his head.  
But scarce the deed was done when from the crowd  
An elder man leaped forth and wailed aloud—  
“My son! my son! avenged thou now shalt be;  
Thy life destroyed, no Prince is there for me!”



This said, he sprang upon the stalwart Aac  
Like maddened brute and roared—"Thy soul is black!  
Defend thy life; strike swift or breathe thy last!"  
While yet he spake his blows fell thick and fast;  
Then Aac, in flaming wrath, stabbed deep his foe;  
Their blood in mingling stream was quick to flow.  
'Twas fierce and brief, the Prince was first to fall,  
But wounded unto death, beyond recall,  
Was he who thus avenged his country's woes  
And brought the reign of Aac to tragic close.

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VII.

Where flows the river Nile, the Queen found rest;  
There once again her days with peace were blest.  
Upon that soil where welcome frank was found,  
Did Móo a giant Sphinx from out the ground  
Cause to arise, and thus Coh's fame renew?  
Did she immortalize her consort true?

As child of Can the natives called her Queen;  
Their ancestors Cans' subjects all had been.  
Móo reigned again, and many a year she dwelt  
In Chem, the Land of Boats. There too she felt  
Her call to liberty, and passed away,  
Rejoiced at last the summons to obey.

"Now cometh bliss! the flesh doth loose its hold;  
Death's tender kiss will leave it still and cold.  
Upon my weary brow the veil of Night  
Descends; my soul leaps forth to joyous flight!  
O touch my heart with thy all-healing balm  
Oblivion sweet! now lull me in thy calm,"  
Móo yearned for this. Then fell upon her ear  
A voice—"Blessèd are they who know not fear!  
The Heart of Heaven e'er radiates love's light,  
And soul released finds nothing to affright  
Save visions false of terror, bred by creeds,  
And deep remorse that gnaws at evil deeds."

Soul stirred, awoke and saw! Herself Móo found.  
Was this the law, tho' not to body bound,  
To still live on? What time in nothingness  
Had fled? Since she besought unconsciousness  
Had ages sped? And now appeared her guide,  
Cay, whom long she mourned when he had died.  
His clear calm eyes again she searched amazed;  
Their power thrilled and drew her as she gazed.

Then murmured she—"If this be happy dream  
Let me dream on." O Light! thy wondrous beam

Throughout creation glows, now and for aye,  
If Will Omnipotent ordaineth day.  
Thy rays are harmonies, celestial Light!  
Because thou art, there is no endless night.  
Earth's weary children long for deep repose;  
But from the glorious light all music flows.  
As night and day forever alternate,  
In darkest silence life doth germinate.

No mortal can conceive th' entrancing sounds  
That greet the spirit freed from terrene bounds.  
Could love's effulgence from supernal spheres  
But reach the mortal eye bedimmed with tears,  
A solace sweet as rain on sun-parched leaf  
Would fall on those bereft and bowed with grief.  
No more would Death a bitter foe appear;  
Kind Hope and Faith would banish Doubt and Fear.

To Múo awaked another rapture flowed—  
Coh's eyes with love unquenched before her's glowed.  
O Love! thou art the power of life, the force  
That lifts the soul; Divinity thy source.  
Ignoble things thy presence doth redeem,  
Sweet breath of God! most holy and supreme!  
Eternal thou, throughout the boundless space;  
Thy purity no act can e'er abase.  
Deep passion broods pent up, in matter dark;  
Death comes, and there upon his gliding bark  
Reality appears; soul finds its own—  
Pure Love released, unmasked, stands forth alone.

By man has time been made the gauge of Earth.  
What cares the soul in realm of spirit birth  
How oft around spin globes above, below?  
Of happiness do beings weary grow?  
Must they return—again to feel the throes  
Of matter's strife—from passionless repose?



SEQUEL.

AGES LATER.

I.

While mortals slept and stars lit up its bed,  
Ere Phoebus smiled the infant's soul had fled.

Kissed by the god of day, a blue-eyed boy  
Sprang from his couch, with eager love and joy.  
White twinkling feet then ran across the floor  
To Natalie, as many a morn before.  
Death's mystery to him was yet untaught;  
The lifeless babe no dread to his mind brought;  
To mother's arms he bore the drooping form—  
“Poor baby cold! make pretty sister warm.”

The lustrums sped. A girl of lightsome heart  
Was told, “He comes! with him thou must depart.”  
To find her in the East, he sailed from West,  
Responsive to the power of soul's request.  
Resistless forces bade her go fulfill  
The part that she, by her own human will  
Had planned upon a day, when swayed by love  
She would her consort find, on earth, above,  
Wherever might he dwell there too would she:  
Attachments deep can bind like stern decree.

To learn the past, to Maya-land both turned,  
But no faint ray of mem'ry in them burned.  
Altho' he murmured in a certain place—  
“Familiar 'tis, there's something I would trace.”

As Maya chief reborn, men of the soil  
Hailed him, and led by him would patient toil  
In forest depths, 'mid desert mansions old  
And temples drear—their history to unfold.

Within a white stone urn in ancient tomb,  
Charred heart and talisman lay in the gloom.  
To her he gave the gem,—“Now take thine own,  
I pray; henceforth it must be thine alone.”



In dancing flame the mortal dust from urn  
Was thrown. "A form ascends from what doth burn!"  
The natives loud exclaimed, "A princely shade  
That into nothingness doth quickly fade."

When evening came, and all from work reposed,  
They told the white man why the things inclosed  
Were found by him: "Thou art returned once more  
From long enchanted sleep; wast here before."  
To this, both earnestly responded—"Nay,"  
But nothing changed; the men thought their own way.

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II.

Fantastic thought cut loose from reason cool  
Are dreams wherein the wisest play the fool.  
Can dreams be memories? Are some portents?  
Who knows? His ignorance man still laments.

The woman dreamed among the Ruins gray,  
Where moon shines in at night and sun by day  
On crumbling floors where powdered bones thick lie  
And glistening serpents glide with gleaming eye.

Now as she seemed to roam in palace drear,  
A man in rich and strange attire drew near,  
Bemoaning thus: "May every wind and leaf  
Re-echo now my wail of hopeless grief!  
In mercy shine upon my endless woe,  
Great Sun! from whom all life and light outflow.

Here crouches Aac, alone from age to age—  
Absorb me now, my wretchedness assuage!  
Remorse, to thee I said, 'Return no more'—  
Thou shalt not stay to goad me as before!  
O Light Eternal! bid this mem'ry die  
While penitent upon the ground I lie.  
Tho' long the years of anguish I have spent,  
The worm gnaws on as if 'twould ne'er relent."  
He prayed and wept. Response came from above—  
A woman's voice replied with pitying love.

Up started he—"Hush! hush! thou knowest not,  
But I know who thou art. O bitter lot!  
To jealous frenzy I became a slave  
And vilely slew my brother true and brave,  
Thus casting o'er my sister's life a blight.  
Still mad with rage and lost to sense of right,  
I crushed my elder brother in my wrath;  
Tho' Pontiff he, I swept him from my path."

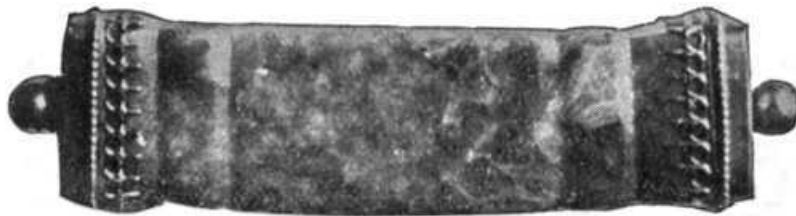
"My vicious mood led many where they fell;

I lied to them that they might serve me well.  
No fiery couch was lit for heroes slain;  
Now I could crawl o'er moldering bones, and fain  
Would lick their dust—so low my haughty head—  
I, lord of all! for whom their blood was shed.  
A tyrant harsh, imbittered I became;  
Nor could my soul's rebuke awaken shame.

O Mother! drop thy tears; accurst for aye  
Am I! the drouth of this, my land, allay.  
Send down thy light, Great Sun!" he cried aloud,  
"Let me forget! with mortal form endowed."

To her he turned again:—"Forgive! forgive!  
Earth-born thro' thee, ah! let me once more live.  
My crimes and victories, *my soul's defeat*,  
My anguish and remorse, wilt thou repeat;  
For thus alone new life may dawn for me—  
In solitude I've long awaited thee."

A falling tear the sighing dreamer woke:  
No mem'ry of the past could she evoke.





III.

Again the Talisman, now set in gold,  
Was worn by woman as in days of old.  
She asked herself, "Doth mystery lurk herein?  
Can we from this some hidden knowledge win?  
Perhaps for us there is a task to do,  
Of bygone times some link to find anew.  
Cold stone! if dowered thou by magic deep,  
What then—if silence thou must ever keep?  
Jadeite grey-green, by ancients called divine,  
Till Earth grow cold this talisman may shine;  
As it hath seen long eons in the past,  
So may it yet man's memory outlast."

'Twas thus the dreamer meditating thought,  
Till by her strong desire some rays were caught.

A mystic clue this stone of magic, yea,  
To scenes of long ago—but find the way.  
Like other million forms, stone hath a soul,  
A spark divine of God the Perfect Whole.  
Then heard the woman toying with the stone:  
"With power was this endowed for thee alone."

What voice thus spake from mind to mind? No sound  
The silence broke, wherein her thought was bound.

"'Tis I, among Earth's men thy friend of old;  
In times long past this page I thee foretold;  
For thou hast been in this, *his* present life,  
His sister one brief year; thou art his wife.  
Attachments deep and strong are ties that bind;  
We ever take the skein again to wind  
Ourselves about with bonds that draw us back,  
And which none other than ourselves can slack.  
He came to give the ancient Maya race  
Its right—on history's page a noble place.  
He would to light restore what's hid away,  
And throw upon the past a clearer ray."



“When we outgrow desire for mundane things—  
Which are but means—our spirit finds its wings.  
When universal love and light are all  
We crave, no power of earth can us inthrall.  
Peace comes alone through matter, which is strife;  
Right effort lifts the soul to purer life.

To do *his* best is all man knows of right—  
Observing this, he finds the spirit’s might.  
To dread the Great Unknown is bondage vile  
For man; this fear’s a sin that doth defile  
The thought and deed of multitudes. In space  
No depth is found where evil can efface  
Love’s holy, constant, all-pervading ray;  
Go where soul will, it need feel no dismay.  
Peace dwells in Heart of Heaven, eternal Ku;  
But in the rugged paths that lead thereto  
With turmoil finite being makes its way—  
Tho’ none know *why* or *whither*, all obey.”

The clasping hand let fall the talisman  
Placed centuries ago, by child of Can,  
To serve as link with mortal heart in urn.  
“Save me from self! I would no more return.”  
The woman breathed. Then at her side appeared  
A radiant form:—“As nothing should be feared  
In all the vast infinity of Good,  
The good is here; and if all mortals would  
Aspire to truth and from ill thought refrain,  
Each could his share of happiness attain.  
No more for safety from thyself appeal,  
Thine higher self doth now itself reveal;  
Its voice obey, for thus thou wilt be free  
To seek and find the joys awaiting thee.

The road thro’ many lives each one must tread,  
And by experience be onward led.

Man's creed saves not, but effort for the right;  
Each his own savior is, thro' valiant fight:  
Endeavor, not success, makes his account.  
Condole we may, but not reproach; all mount  
The heights; tho' some may tarry long behind;  
The law of being, each to all doth bind."

"Our blundering steps oft bring upon us woe;  
To fail to strive entails a keener throe.  
The hounded, luckless inmate of the jail  
May greater effort make, without avail,  
Than judge who sits upon the bench to give  
Decree—if prisoner may or may not live.  
For one, the right may be an easy way;  
In vain the other struggles to obey  
Himself, the spark divine that seeks to guide  
Thro' matter's maze, and with him e'er will 'bide  
Go where he may, in crime, in paths of pain;  
Till step by step, the summit he shall gain."

"The woes we feel; the failures we deplore;  
Are only means to reach a fairer shore.  
When body falls to dust and soul escapes,  
The thoughts that grieved fade too, like phantom shapes.  
No judge is there to measure out our doom,  
Or thrust us into everlasting gloom.  
Ourselves we may condemn if we have failed  
To do our *best*. But man has oft bewailed  
As sin some harmless deed, and cast no blame  
On other acts that should bear stamp of shame."

"This truth thou may'st enshrine within thy heart:  
Of Life and Love Eternal we are part;  
The Will Supreme is One, and lives in all;  
This God, our holy self, can never fall.  
WILL is the law; then will the right, for aye!  
Right will is all that mortal need obey."  
Art bound to flesh?—thy spirit thus decreed;

This thou shalt realize again when freed.  
Would'st thou repose? Resume the active way?  
Thus shall it be: none may thy will gainsay.

OUR will divine ordains we do OUR best;  
If we do this, the future must attest  
That where we passed we made love's tendrils twine  
And hope's soft beam from many an eye to shine.  
Love may for some mean but a fond caress;  
But tenderly to serve is to express  
Devotion, love's best gift, whence doth ascend  
A fragrant incense which to earth can lend  
A sweeter air, a rosier light, and make  
Grand harmonies on mortal ear to break.

Eternal Love upholds thee, knows thy need;  
Thou art in bounteous life, accept its meed;  
Respond with all the love thou hast. Receive  
Celestial Light and, if thy heart must grieve,  
Be strong of soul; nor turn away thine ear  
From that soul's song, inspired by vision clear:  
For ALL is well! Give to despair no heed;  
Reject it; 'tis a dank, pernicious weed.

The darkest hour, the murkiest place of woe,  
The direst crime, most agonizing throe,  
Shall yet give way before the Light Divine  
Which dwells in all that is, and forth will shine.  
List to the melodies the soul doth sing,  
Vibrating chords that unto heart shall bring  
A joyous symphony whose voices give  
Rich harmonies that evermore will live.

Rejoice in life; rejoice yet more when Death,  
Whose holy kiss absorbs our fleeting breath,  
Draws nigh, a friend who lets us out to play  
In broader fields of universal day.  
Rejoice for all that lives, and all that dies;

The piteous cry, the sunny smile, both rise;  
For these are prayers that will The Good attain,  
Where all shall blend in one triumphant strain.

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[see page 38]

*Plate XII.*

# THE LOVER'S SONG.

From "Queen Moo's Talisman"

Words and Melody by ALICE LE PLONGEON.

Accompaniment by IDA SIMMONS.

*Moderato*

The musical score is written for voice and piano. It begins with a piano introduction in 3/4 time, marked *Moderato*. The introduction consists of two systems of piano accompaniment. The first system has five measures, with a *dim* (diminuendo) marking in the fourth measure. The second system also has five measures, with *p* (piano) and *pp* (pianissimo) markings in the first and third measures, and a *rit* (ritardando) marking in the fifth measure. The vocal melody enters in the third measure of the first system. The lyrics are presented in two verses. The piano accompaniment continues throughout the vocal lines, with a *mf a tempo* marking in the first system of the vocal section. The score concludes with a final piano accompaniment system.

1. Ah! bird so gay Take not thy flight; With dul-cet lay  
2. Ah! floweret fair, With breath of Morn Up-on the air

*mf a tempo*

My heart de-light! Stay by me here, For thou art dear -  
Thy per-fume's borne; Thy life's too fleet, For thou art sweet -

Tho' one I love Is yet more dear!  
 Tho' one I love Is yet more sweet.

*dim.* *rit.* *p* *pp*

3. Ah! lim-pid dew, Fair pearl of Night - That doth a -

*p*

new To pe-tal bright Give charm to lure - Thou art so

*cresc.*

pure! Tho' one I love Is just as pure.

*dim.*

[Listen] *Music available in html.*

1. Ah! bird so gay Take not thy flight; With dulcet lay  
My heart delight! Stay by me here, For thou art dear  
Tho' one I love Is yet more dear!

2. Ah! floweret fair, With breath of Morn Upon the air  
Thy perfume's borne; Thy life's too fleet, For thou art sweet  
Tho' one I love Is yet more sweet.

3. Ah! limpid dew, Fair pearl of Night That doth a-  
new To petal bright Give charm to lure Thou art so  
pure! Tho' one I love Is just as pure.

[see page 36]

Plate IX.

## Invocation to the Sun.

**Moderato.**  
*marcato*



Lord of day we are Thine; On our path deign to shine

*rit.*



Ho - ly Light! Mor - tals glo - ry in Thy might; When Night

*rit.*



flees be - fore Thy ray We our voi - ces lift, and pray. Great Light.

*This is also the melody of the "PRAYER TO THE RAIN-GODS".*

[Listen] *Music available in html.*

Lord of day we are Thine; On our path deign to shine  
Holy Light! Mortals glory in Thy might; When Night  
flees before Thy ray We our voices lift, and pray Great Light.



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[see page 36]     *Plate X.*

## He and She.

**Allegretto.**



*HE.* Hear life's jin-gle, come a-long! All should min-gle with the throng.  
Clasp my hand, dear, haste with me. Say not nay, for I love thee!  
*SHE.* Quit thy non-sense or be-gone! I am not thus light-ly won.  
*HE.* Let's go on-ward to the dance; Give me but one ten-der glance!  
*SHE.* Cease thy teas-ing, I'll not go! 'Tis de-cid-ed, thou must know.  
*HE.* Hear life's jin-gle! join the throng; Youth and pleas-ure stay not long.

[Listen] *Music available in html.*

*HE.* Hear life's jingle, come along! All should mingle with the throng.  
Clasp my hand, dear, haste with me Say not nay, for I love thee!

*SHE.* Quit thy non-sense or begone! I am not thus lightly won.

*HE.* Lets go onward to the dance; Give me but one tender glance!

*SHE.* Cease thy teasing, I'll not go! 'Tis decided, thou must know.

*HE.* Hear life's jingle! join the throng; Youth and pleasure stay not long.

[see page 37]

Plate XI.

## The Dancers' Song.

**Moderato.**



On our dress of spot-less white We are  
wreath-ing gar-lands' bright; And will sing, kiss, sip, With  
laugh-ing, rud-dy lip, Far a-way in-to the night.  
**Lentando**  
Days of glad-ness soon take flight; Love's sweet  
**a tempo**  
nec-tar do not slight. Let us sing, kiss, sip, And light-  
**rit.**  
heart-ed gai-ly trip, While our vows we once more plight. —

[Listen] [Music available in html.](#)

On our dress of spotless white We are  
wreathing garlands bright; And will sing, kiss, sip, With  
laughing, ruddy lip, Far away into the night.

Days of gladness soon take flight; Love's sweet  
nectar do not slight Let us sing, kiss, sip, And light-  
hearted gaily trip, While our vows we once more plight.

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[see page 38]      *Plate XIII.*

**Funeral Chant.**

**Lento.**

Thro' earth - life our foot - steps lead; Guide us  
Speed thee now to realm of bliss; Cast from  
in - to peace e - ter - nal; Till from all de - sire  
thee all thought of strife; Tho each eye thy face  
we're freed, And per - ceive Thy Light su - per - nal,  
will miss; And we mourn thee all our life!

[Listen] *Music available in html.*

Thro' earth-life our footsteps lead; Guide us  
into peace eternal; Till from all desire  
we're freed, And perceive Thy Light supernal.

Speed thee now to realm of bliss; Cast from  
thee all thought of strife; Tho each eye thy face  
will miss; And we mourn thee all our life!

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### Transcriber's notes

1. Silently corrected typographical errors and inconsistencies; retained non-standard spelling.
2. Illustrated drop caps have not been retained.
3. Plate IV was moved to page 43.
4. The caption of the plates have been moved under each plate.
5. The Lover's Song (100-101.png) - Bar 18, piano bass staff, lower note of chord corrected to F.
6. Mayan character [accented ä] has been replaced with ā.

\*\*\* END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK QUEEN MOO'S  
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